Ascentis
Awarding Organisation

Name _____

Student ID _____

Tutor name _____

Course Code _____

CARDIFF AND VALE COLLEGE ESOL

LEVEL 2 READING BOOKLET

Cardiff and Vale College
Coleg Caerdydd a'r Fro

Timetable

Day	Time	Location	Teacher

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ESOL LEARNER AGREEMENT

Before you study ESOL, you must agree to:

1. ATTENDANCE

You should have <u>100% attendance.</u> This includes face to face classes in college, online sessions and independent study.
If you cannot come to college or attend your online session, you *must* tell your teacher *before* the start of class.
You will have a meeting with a teacher if within a given month your attendance falls below 90% for full-time students or 87% for part-time students.

2. PUNCTUALITY

You will arrive on time for the start of *all* classes.
If you are more than 10 minutes late, you cannot join the class and will have to wait until the next session.

3. HOMEWORK & INDEPENDENT STUDY

You should study independently for approximately 4-8 hours per week (part-time students).

4. PART-TIME EMPLOYMENT

Work hours or other commitments should not be at the same time as your class timetable.

5. EXAMS & EXPECTATIONS

All students should achieve the qualification attached to their course.
Exam entry is not guaranteed and neither is progression. Exam entry and progression will depend on progress tests, exam results, homework submission and attendance. **Your teacher will decide if you are ready to take your exams. This is the final decision.**
Exams are planned to take place within the final two weeks of the course.

6. PHONES

Phones must be switched off during class time unless otherwise directed by your teacher for use as part of the lesson.

7. PROGRESS WEEK

All students must successfully complete the first half-term, including Progress Week, to stay on the course.

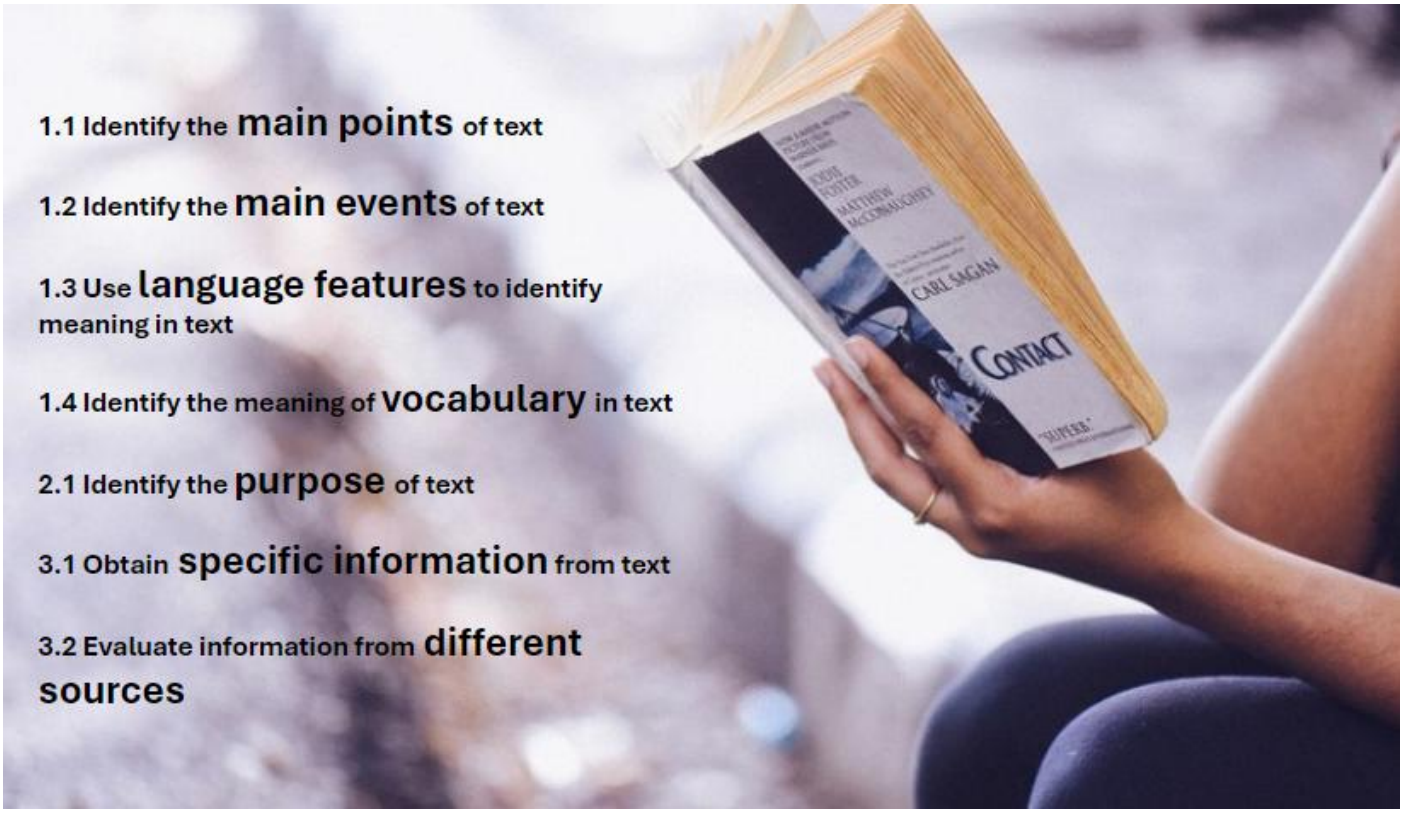
SIGNED: _____ **DATE:** _____

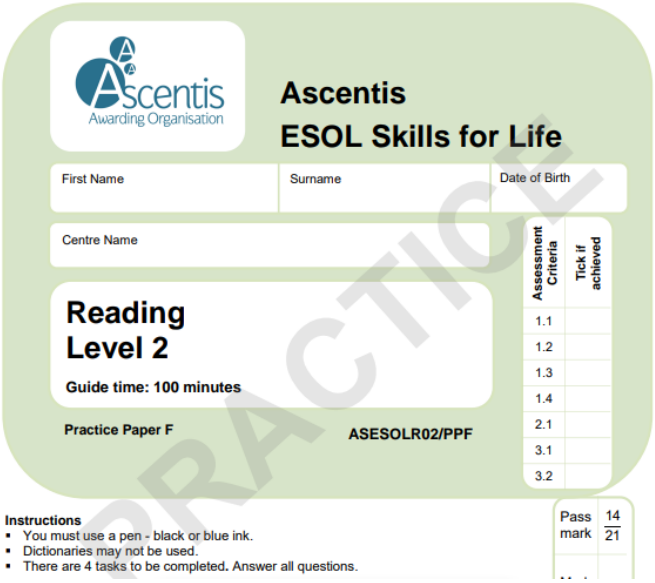
Reading Overview

To pass the Ascentis Level 2 Reading exam, you will need both:

- **to score the pass mark of 14/21 or higher**
- **to answer at least *one* question correctly for each of the assessment criteria below**

If you have difficulty with any of the question types, set it as an ILP target for extra study and support.





Ascentis
Awarding Organisation

Ascentis
ESOL Skills for Life

First Name	Surname	Date of Birth

Centre Name

Reading
Level 2

Guide time: 100 minutes

Practice Paper F

ASESOLR02/PPF

Assessment Criteria	Tick if achieved
1.1	
1.2	
1.3	
1.4	
2.1	
3.1	
3.2	

Instructions
- You must use a pen - black or blue ink.
- Dictionaries may not be used.
- There are 4 tasks to be completed. Answer all questions.

Pass mark 14/21

PRACTICE

Read lots! Read often.

Week 1 Reading diagnostic test

(*Adapted from Cambridge Level 1 past paper A*)

L2 Reading diagnostic test Feedback.pptx

Task: Read the texts and answer the questions that follow them by circling the correct letter.

LEGOLAND

Legoland is the UK's most unique theme park. It was opened in 1996 and features over 53 million Lego bricks. Situated in the south of the UK, it is 2 miles from the centre of Windsor. Children between the ages of 6 and 13 years can visit The Dragon Driving School and master road skills. They will earn their very own driving licence. Legoland accepts all major credit and debit cards, and there are cash machines located around the park.

DRAYTON MANOR

Drayton Manor is the UK's largest family-owned theme park. It is situated near Birmingham and Coventry, in the very heart of the country. Visit Thomas Land, where special events and train rides are organised during July and August; see rare and exotic animals from tigers and chimps to penguins and parrots. Check the website for opening and closing times. British weather is _____ , so come prepared for anything. If it rains, we can supply ponchos.

THORPE PARK

Thorpe Park is the UK's most thrilling theme park and has some incredible rides. During October there are terrifying Fright Nights which only the brave will survive. Thorpe Park is 20 miles from London; leave the M25 at junction 11 or junction 13. For visitors who want to extend their stay, there's The Crash Pad near the entrance, a hotel whose facilities include ensuite bathrooms, flat-screen TVs and WiFi.

ALTON TOWERS

Alton Towers is the UK's most popular theme park and has great rides. There are plenty of attractions for all ages, and beautiful gardens where you can enjoy a relaxing stroll. The park is situated in the heart of the UK near Manchester and Birmingham and can easily be reached by train and bus. It opens daily at 9.30 between mid-March and mid-October. Family tickets are available, and you can save money by booking online.

CHESSINGTON WORLD OF ADVENTURES

Chessington is the ultimate family theme park with legendary rides and a fabulous zoo which includes a sea-life centre. It is within easy reach of London, and it will cost only £2 for an all-day parking ticket. The park opens daily at 10am, but closing times vary throughout the year, so check the website for details. There are three great gift shops for wonderful souvenirs of your visit.

1. **At how many theme parks can visitors see animals?**

A 1

B 2

C 3

D 4

2. At which theme park are there special events in Autumn?

A Legoland
B Drayton Manor
C Thorpe Park
D Alton Towers

3. Which review mentions public transport?

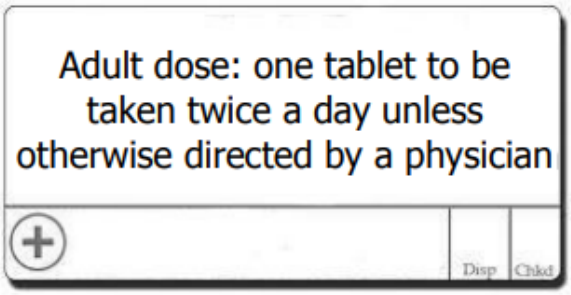
A Legoland
B Drayton Manor
C Thorpe Park
D Alton Towers

4. What does whose refer to in the review of Thorpe Park?

A hotel
B entrance
C facilities
D bathrooms

5. Which word should be used to fill the gap in the review for Drayton Manor?

A undesirable
B unfavourable
C unpredictable
D uncomfortable



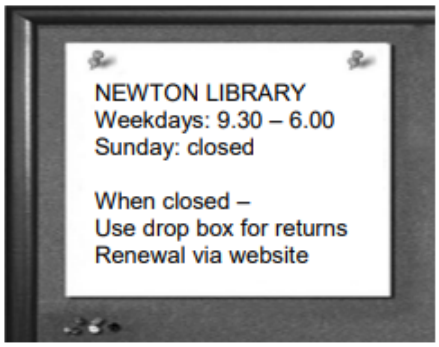
These instructions mean that

A you should take two tablets each day.

B you may give these tablets to children.

C you must ask your doctor how many tablets to take.

6.



This notice tells you that

A you may borrow books seven days a week.

B you can return books at any time.

C you must renew books online.

7.

8.

This notice instructs passengers to

A ask permission before sitting in the seat.

B offer the seat to certain passengers.

C ensure that only people in need sit in the seat.

As soon as I started my college course, I began to look for some work experience. It was a full-time course, but I had a free day each week. I wanted to do all I could to make myself employable. I'm like many students, I think. We all know jobs are difficult to find these days. The thought of leaving college with a certificate to say I was qualified, but with no job to go to was alarming. This encouraged me to go out and look for work experience placements.

I had several different placements. I decided I must make the most of every opportunity. I quickly realised that the way to impress potential employers is to show that you are ready to work hard. They don't want someone who just does what they are asked and makes the tea. I took every placement I was offered even if it wasn't to do with my course. Sometimes I wrote to firms that hadn't even advertised.

Among the things I did were working at a radio station and on a local newspaper. I think it's been more useful than just reading books. You do need to study, of course, but college doesn't teach you everything. The very best thing is that I have much more confidence now. I'm ready to tackle anything. My CV looks better too. While I was working at the radio station, I met a lot of interesting people. Some of them may help me find work in the future. I certainly recommend getting some work experience while you're studying.

9. What is the writer trying to do in this article?

A outline the difficulty of finding work

B stress the value of work experience

C explain the success she has had at work

D describe some interesting work she's done

10. What does the word This refer to in the first paragraph?

A knowing she'd have a good qualification

B getting to the end of her course

C fearing she wouldn't find a job

D having plenty of spare time

11. The writer thinks the best way to get a work experience placement is to...

A show possible employers how keen you are

B apply for as many jobs as possible

C choose work related to your studies

D read advertisements very carefully

12. The writer says the most useful thing she's gained from work experience is...

A an impressive CV to show employers

B the support of several helpful friends

C a more positive and confident attitude

D a practical skill you can't learn from books

13. Which of the following would be the best title for this article?

A How to tackle your first job

B How to present an effective CV

C How to get the most from student life

D How to prepare for the world of work

New Message

From: Human Resources Dept

To: All staff

Subject: First Aider training

We are offering staff the opportunity to receive training as first aiders. The training will be given by paramedics from the local hospital. They will provide the skills and the knowledge to deal with emergencies in the workplace.

For more information, reply to this email.

Who does They refer to?

A the Human Resources Dept

B the paramedics

C the staff

14.

SHOP ASSISTANTS REQUIRED
We are looking for reliable, hard-working and enthusiastic people to work in our new supermarket. Applicants must have at least one year's experience in retail.
Monday - Friday 9-5
Uniform Provided

Which person is most suitable for this job?

A someone who is looking for his first job

B someone who goes to college on a Friday morning

C someone who used to work in a bookshop for three years

15.

Week 2 Reading Practice 1.1

Reading AC 1.1

Identifying the main idea of a text is crucial for understanding and summarising what you read. The main idea is the central point or message that the author wants to convey.

To find it, start by reading the text carefully and paying attention to the first and last sentences of each paragraph, as they often contain key information. Look for repeated words or phrases that highlight important concepts.

Task: Read each paragraph and then summarise the main idea in exactly 12 words below.

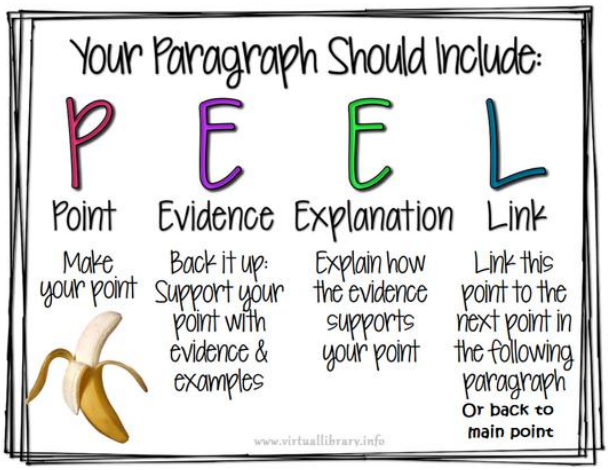
a) Smoking was banned in public closed spaces in the UK to protect public health and reduce exposure to second-hand smoke. The ban was implemented after extensive research showed the harmful effects of second-hand smoke on non-smokers, including increased risks of respiratory diseases, heart disease and cancer. The Health Act 2006 introduced the legislation, and the ban came into effect in England on July 1, 2007, following earlier implementations in Scotland (2006), Wales (2007), and Northern Ireland (2007). This move aimed to create healthier environments in workplaces, restaurants, pubs and other indoor public spaces, ensuring cleaner air and promoting overall public well-being.

Write a summary in exactly 12 words:

b) Stepping off the plane and into the heart of Paris last summer felt like walking into a dream. The moment I saw the Eiffel Tower in the distance, my heart leapt with excitement. The streets were alive with the scent of fresh croissants and the chatter of people speaking in French. As I strolled down the cobblestone avenues, the stunning architecture of centuries-old buildings took my breath away. The Seine River shimmered under the sun. I couldn't resist stopping at every little café, marvelling at the effortless elegance of the Parisians. It was my first taste of true adventure, and I was completely captivated by the city's beauty and charm.

Write a summary in exactly 12 words:

As mentioned above, to find the main idea of a text, you should focus on the first sentence of each paragraph, as it holds the key to understanding.



In good paragraph structure for articles/essays, the first sentence is called the *topic sentence*. It communicates the main point of the paragraph.

The next sentences that form the main body of the paragraph then support that point, providing evidence, examples and explanation.

The last sentence of the paragraph concludes the point and helps transition to the next point that follows in another paragraph.

Task: Read the two topic sentences below, they are the first sentences of different paragraphs.

1) Investing your money in Bitcoin can offer substantial benefits.

2) However, investing in Bitcoin also comes with considerable risks.

Based on these two topic sentences only, what is the article about? Write one clear, correct sentence.

_____

_____

_____

Task: Read the two paragraphs on the following page. On the lines below, identify using key words and phrases the points, evidence, examples and explanation.

Paragraph 1

Point

_____

E

_____

E

_____

E

_____

Paragraph 2
Point

E

E

E

Paragraph 1

Investing your money in Bitcoin can offer substantial benefits. One of the most significant advantages is the potential for **high returns**. Bitcoin has experienced dramatic price increases over the past 10 years, providing investors with the opportunity to earn **substantial profits**. Additionally, Bitcoin offers quite a lot of **financial independence** and **security**, as it is decentralised and not controlled by any government or bank. This can be particularly appealing in times of economic uncertainty, as Bitcoin is often seen as a "digital gold" that can protect against **inflation** and **currency devaluation**.

Paragraph 2

However, investing in Bitcoin also comes with considerable risks. The most notable risk is its high **volatility**. Bitcoin's price can fluctuate wildly within short periods, leading to significant losses if the market moves against your investment. Furthermore, the **regulatory environment** for cryptocurrencies is still developing, and changes in laws or government policies could negatively impact Bitcoin's **value** and **accessibility**. Security concerns are also high, as digital wallets and exchanges have been targets for **hackers**, potentially resulting in the loss of your investment. Given these risks, it is crucial to thoroughly research and carefully consider your financial situation before investing in Bitcoin.

Vocabulary Task: Match the meaning of the phrases in the box with the definitions below.

1. high returns
2. inflation
3. financial independence & security
4. volatility
5. hackers
6. currency devaluation
7. value
8. regulatory environment
9. accessibility
10. substantial profits

a. the rate of increase in prices over a given period of time
b. a large amount of money you get when you are paid more for something than it cost you to make, get, or do it.
c. the quality of being easy to approach, reach, enter, speak with, use or understand
d. how much something is worth, either in terms of cash or importance
e. a state of being likely to change suddenly, especially by becoming worse
f. people who break into a computer system
g. the decrease in the value of a country's money
h. people/organisations appointed by government to control an industry such as banking
i. how much money is earned relative to the amount of money spent on an investment
j. having enough money to stop working and not depend on anyone else to support you

Task: Read the article and identify the topic sentences that are missing from the list provided below. There is one extra sentence that you do not need to use.

The Pros and Cons of Following Fashion Trends

By ChatGPT

_____ Fashion can be fun and exciting, but it also has its downsides. Let's explore the advantages and disadvantages of staying trendy.

_____ When you wear clothes that are in style, you might feel more attractive and receive compliments from others. For example, if you had been wearing the latest sneakers, *you would have been admired* by your friends.

_____ Fashion allows you to show who you are without saying a word. Unique trends *can be adopted* to create a look that is entirely your own. Imagine how your style *could have been transformed* if you had discovered that quirky hat trend earlier!

_____ Keeping up with fashion trends can be expensive. Trendy clothes and accessories are often more costly than classic items. You might find yourself spending a lot of money on things that will soon be out of fashion.

_____ This pressure can be stressful, especially when new trends are constantly being introduced. If you had felt less stressed about your appearance, you *might have enjoyed* social events more.

_____ Something that was fashionable last month might be outdated now. This means that your wardrobe needs to be updated frequently, which is not always practical.

_____ Fast fashion, where trends change rapidly and cheaply made clothes are quickly discarded, has a significant impact on the planet. The production of these garments often involves harmful chemicals and large amounts of water, which can pollute the environment. If more sustainable practices *had been adopted* by the fashion industry, less damage *would have been done* to our ecosystems. Indeed, discarded clothing often ends up in landfills, contributing to waste and pollution.

_____ It can boost your confidence and allow you to express your personality, but it can also be expensive and stressful. By being more mindful of our fashion choices and supporting sustainable brands, we can help reduce the environmental footprint of our wardrobes. If fashion is fun for you, go ahead and enjoy it! But remember, it's okay to skip a trend or two if it doesn't suit you or your budget. After all, true style is about feeling comfortable and confident in whatever you choose to wear.

Topic Sentences

a) Fashion is absolutely essential for everyone all around the world.
b) Have you ever wondered whether keeping up with the latest fashion trends is worth it?
c) In conclusion, keeping up with the latest fashion trends has both advantages and disadvantages.
d) Another downside is the pressure to always look perfect.
e) Firstly, following fashion trends can make you feel confident.

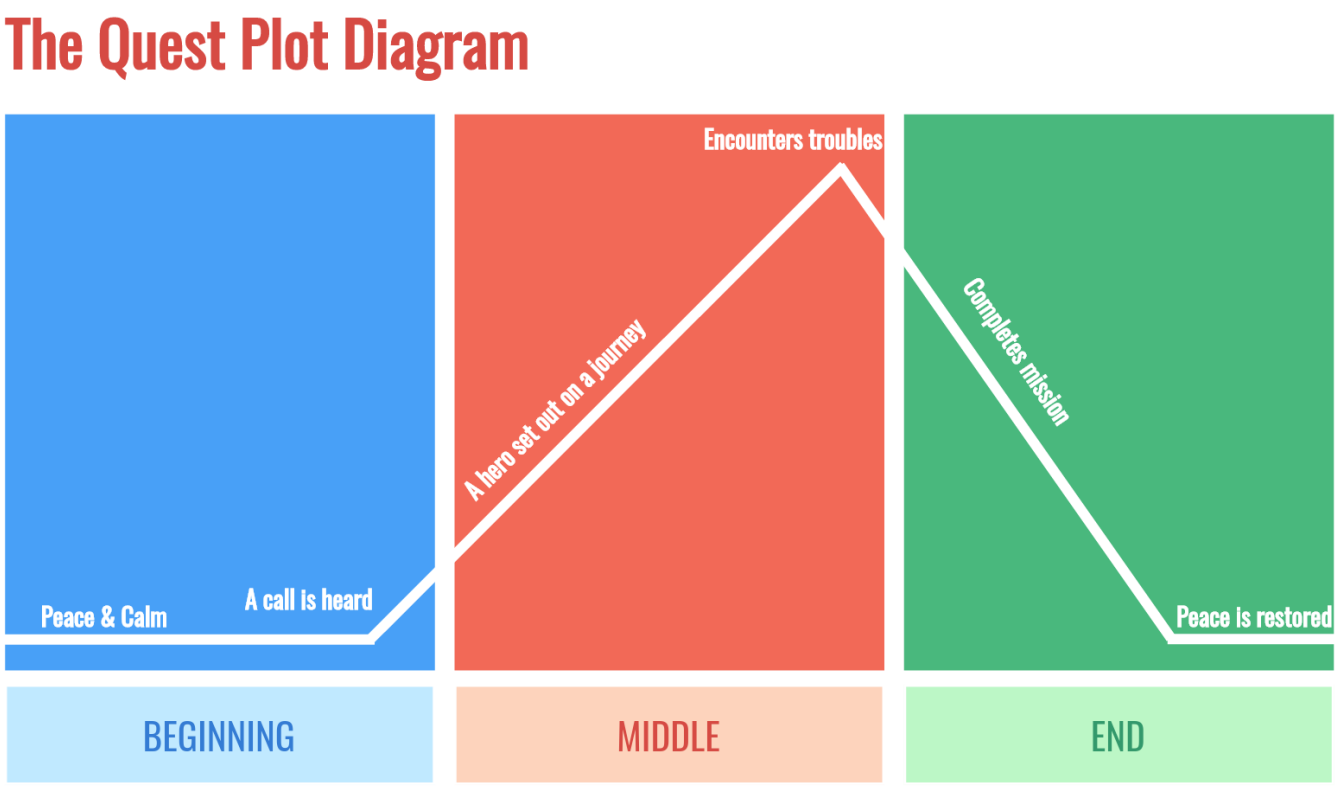
f) In addition, trends can change quickly, making it hard to keep up.
g) Another advantage is the chance to express your personality.
h) However, there are also some disadvantages to consider.
i) Furthermore, it is important to consider the environmental costs of the fashion industry.

Week 3 Reading Practice 1.2

Reading AC 1.2

Identifying the main events of a text involves focusing on the sequence of key actions. For example, in a narrative this would mean the crucial turning points that drive the plot forward and shape the overall story.

Here is a diagram that outlines the basic plot sequence of one kind of narrative:



Task: Read the adventure below and then plot the main events in sequence on the plot diagram on the following page.

In a land where the mountains touched the sky and forests whispered secrets, generations lived a peaceful existence for many centuries. It had always been a fertile land of abundance, beautiful and tranquil. The people were wealthy and content.

However, everything changed when the kingdom of Eldoria was suddenly thrown into grave danger. An ancient curse had been unleashed, turning the once-vibrant land into a realm of shadows. Crops withered,

rivers ran dry, and a chilling fog enveloped the villages. The people of Eldoria were desperate, their hope dwindling with each passing day.

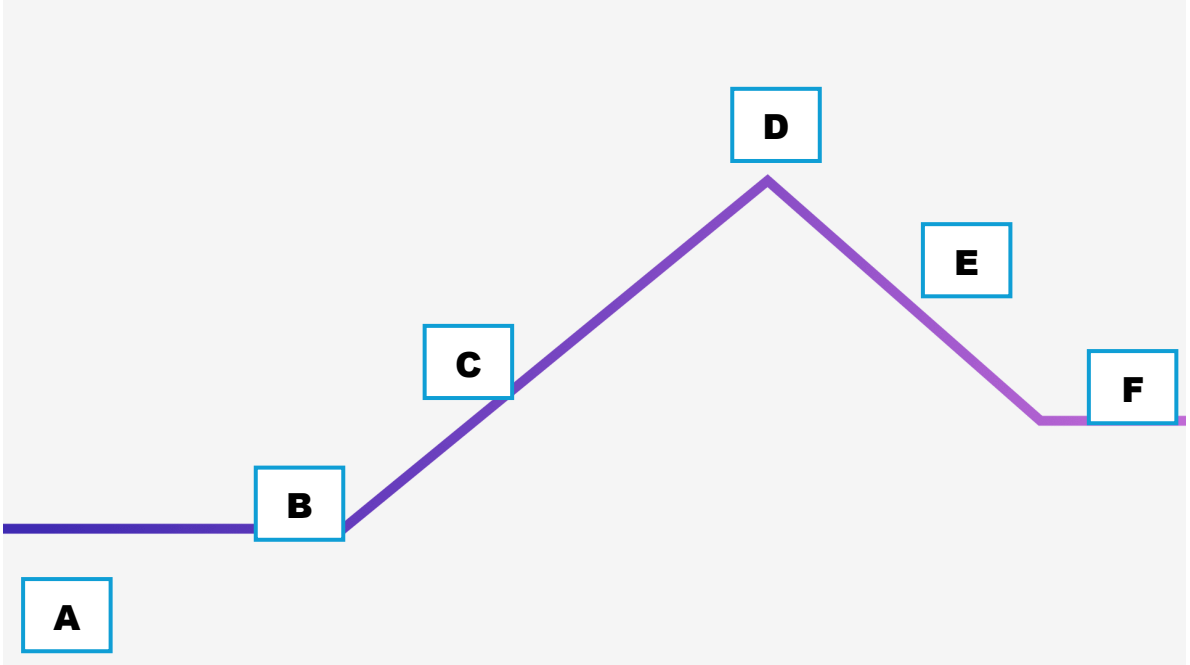
In this dark hour, a magical band of heroes emerged.

Led by the wise elf, Elara, whose knowledge of ancient spells was unmatched, the group set out on a quest to find the Crystal of Light, the only artefact capable of breaking the curse. With her were Thrain, a dwarf with unmatched strength and a heart of gold; Mira, a nimble thief whose quick fingers and quicker wit often saved the day; and Lyra, a sorceress whose powerful magic was as unpredictable as it was potent.

Their journey was fraught with peril. They braved the treacherous peaks of Mount Tharok, where they battled ice trolls and avoided avalanches. In the dense and eerie Whispering Woods, they faced off against enchanted creatures that sought to lead them astray. Yet, it was in the depths of the Forgotten Caves that they encountered their greatest challenge: a dragon with scales like midnight and breath of fire.

Through bravery, cunning and unwavering teamwork, they defeated the beast and retrieved the Crystal of Light!

Returning to Eldoria, Elara cast the spell that shattered the curse, restoring the kingdom to its former glory. The land blossomed once more, rivers flowed freely, and the fog lifted, revealing a bright and hopeful future. The heroes were celebrated across Eldoria, their names becoming legends whispered by the wind, reminding all that even in the darkest times, courage and friendship could light the way.



A _____

_____

B _____

_____

C _____

_____

D _____

_____

E _____

_____

F _____

_____

Week 4 Reading Practice 3.1

Reading AC 3.1

A basic skill in reading comprehension is being able to obtain specific information from a text. This means you can find facts, dates or other details.

Task: Complete the following sentence starters…

Skimming is… _____

Scanning is… _____

Close reading is… _____

When searching through a text for specific information, use a combination of scanning and close reading. First, you have to read the question carefully to understand what is asked for. Then, scan through the text for related words or phrases. When you find one, read the sentence closely to confirm if it has the answer you need or not. If yes, great! If not, no worries. Just continue scanning for another associated key word or phrase.

Task: Read the article on the next page and answer the comprehension questions below.

1. What is digital literacy?

_____

2. How might a nurse use digital tools in their job?

_____

3. Why are critical thinking and problem-solving skills important in today's job market?

_____

4. Give an example of a role that requires critical thinking and problem-solving.

_____

5. What is emotional intelligence?

_____

6. How can emotional intelligence improve a workplace environment?

_____

7. Why is adaptability important in the modern job market?

_____

8. Describe an example of adaptability in the context of teaching.

_____

9. What does collaboration involve?

_____

11. Provide an example of how collaboration is used in software development.

Employable Skills for the Future

In today's rapidly changing world, the skills needed to be employable are also evolving. As technology advances and the job market transforms, certain skills are becoming increasingly valuable. Here, we will explore some of these critical skills and provide real-life examples to illustrate their importance.

Digital Literacy

Digital literacy refers to the ability to use digital tools and technologies effectively. In nearly every job, from retail to medicine, employees need to know how to operate computers, use software and navigate the internet. For example, a nurse might use digital tools to track patient records, while a marketing professional may analyse social media trends to create campaigns. Companies now look for employees who can easily adapt to new digital platforms.

Critical Thinking and Problem-Solving

Critical thinking and problem-solving skills are essential in a world where automation is taking over many routine tasks. These skills involve analysing information, thinking creatively and making decisions. Consider the role of an engineer working on renewable energy solutions. They must evaluate different technologies, foresee potential problems and develop innovative solutions to make clean energy more accessible. Employers value individuals who can tackle complex issues effectively.

Emotional Intelligence

Emotional intelligence is the ability to understand and manage your own emotions and those of others. In the workplace, this translates to better teamwork, communication and conflict resolution. For instance, a manager with high emotional intelligence can motivate their team, recognise when someone is struggling and provide the necessary support. This skill is crucial in creating a positive work environment and improving employee satisfaction.

Adaptability and Flexibility

The ability to adapt and be flexible is becoming more important as the nature of work changes. Jobs that didn't exist a few years ago are now in high demand, such as social media managers and app developers. An example of adaptability is a teacher who shifted from in-person classes to online teaching during the COVID-19 pandemic. They had to quickly learn how to use virtual platforms and keep students engaged remotely. Being adaptable means being open to change and willing to learn new skills.

Collaboration

Collaboration involves working effectively with others to achieve common goals. In many industries, projects require teamwork, often with colleagues from different backgrounds and expertise. A good example is a software development team where programmers, designers and testers must work together to create a new application. Collaboration ensures that diverse ideas are considered and that the final product meets high standards.

Creativity and Innovation

Creativity and innovation are about thinking outside the box and coming up with new ideas. These skills are valuable in fields like marketing, product design and entertainment. A real-life example is a product designer who invents a new gadget that solves a common problem in a unique way. Companies seek creative individuals who can drive progress and set them apart from competitors.

In conclusion, the future job market will reward those who are digitally literate, critical thinkers, emotionally intelligent, adaptable, collaborative and creative. By developing these skills, individuals can enhance their employability and succeed in a dynamic world.

Week 5 Reading Practice 1.3

Reading AC 1.3

You will need to identify language features that are used for effect in a text. For these questions, specific terminology may be needed.

For example, how do you know if you are reading a *newspaper article*?

Possible answers could include: _____

_____

_____

For example, how do you know if you are reading something on a *website*?

Possible answers could include: _____

_____

_____

Task: For each of the following terms:

a. **Look it up online**
b. **identify what it is (a)**
c. **give an example of how it might be used in a text (b)**

Acronyms	a)
	b)
Subheadings	a)
	b)
Captions	a)
	b)
Imperatives	a)
	b)
Bullet points	a)
	b)

Idioms add colour to the language and are commonly used in everyday British conversation.

Task: Match the popular British idioms on the left along with their explanations on the right:

a) Piece of cake	i)	*To reveal a secret*
b) Bite the bullet	ii)	*It is up to you to make the next decision or take action*
c) The ball is in your court	iii)	*The final problem in a series that makes a situation unbearable*
d) Break the ice	iv)	*Asking someone what they are thinking*
e) A penny for your thoughts	v)	*Pursuing a mistaken or misguided line of thought or action*
f) The last straw	vi)	*To initiate conversation in a social setting*
g) Cost an arm and a leg	vii)	*To describe exactly what is causing a situation or problem*
h) Let the cat out of the bag	viii)	*To be very expensive*
i) Hit the nail on the head	ix)	*Something very easy to do*
j) Barking up the wrong tree	x)	*To face a difficult situation bravely*

k) Burn the midnight oil	xi)	*To do something in the easiest, quickest or cheapest way, compromising quality*
l) Cut corners	xii)	*To work late into the night*

Week 6 Reading Practice 1.4

Reading AC 1.4

An area of continual growth when learning a language is vocabulary. Make an effort to keep a record of new and interesting words, copy them into your notes and practise using them in your speaking and writing.

Here are 20 important words an upper-intermediate ESOL learner should learn:

1. Analyse	*To examine something in detail for purposes of explanation and interpretation.*
2. Assume	*To take something for granted without proof.*
3. Concept	*An abstract idea or general notion.*
4. Context	*The circumstances or setting surrounding an event or situation.*
5. Criteria	*Standards or principles by which something is judged or decided.*
6. Emphasise	*To give special importance or prominence to something in speaking or writing.*
7. Evaluate	*To assess or determine the value, significance, or extent of something.*
8. Hypothesis	*A proposed explanation made on the basis of limited evidence as a starting point for further investigation.*
9. Implement	*To put a decision, plan, agreement, etc., into effect.*
10. Interpret	*To explain the meaning of information, words or actions.*
11. Justify	*To show or prove to be right or reasonable.*
12. Method	*A particular procedure for accomplishing or approaching something.*
13. Objective	*A goal or aim; not influenced by personal feelings or opinions.*
14. Perspective	*A particular attitude toward or way of regarding something; a point of view.*
15. Policy	*A course or principle of action adopted or proposed by an organisation or individual.*
16. Procedure	*An established or official way of doing something.*

17. Significant *Sufficiently great or important to be worthy of attention.*

18. Structure *The arrangement or framework of a sentence, paragraph or entire work.*

19. Theory *A supposition or a system of ideas intended to explain something.*

20. Validate *To check or prove the validity or accuracy of something.*

Task: Choose 5 of the words above and write sentences below:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

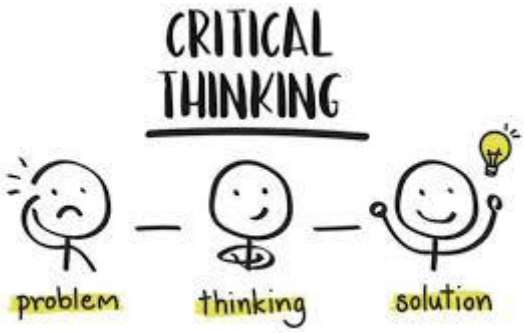
_____

_____

Task: Read the article below and underline any words found from the top 20 list.

The Importance of Critical Thinking in Education

By: ChatGPT



In today's fast-paced world, the ability to analyse information critically has become more important than ever. Students are often required to evaluate various concepts and interpret data to form their own perspectives. This process not only involves understanding the context in which information is presented but also the ability to implement different methods to assess its validity.

One key objective in education is to foster critical thinking skills. By emphasising the importance of these skills, educators aim to prepare students to navigate complex situations in their personal and professional lives. For instance, when students develop a hypothesis, they must gather evidence and use specific criteria to justify their conclusions. This approach ensures that their findings are not just based on assumptions but are supported by sound reasoning and analysis.

Another crucial aspect of critical thinking is the ability to understand and apply different theories. These theories provide a structured way to look at problems and can help in formulating effective solutions. However, it's also important for students to remain objective and not let personal biases cloud their judgment. By adhering to established procedures and policies, they can maintain a consistent and reliable approach to problem-solving.

Furthermore, the structure of an argument plays a significant role in how effectively it is communicated. A well-structured argument that is logically sound and supported by evidence will be more convincing and impactful. Educators encourage students to develop these skills to enhance their ability to communicate complex ideas clearly.

Task: In your own words, define each of the following terms.

1. **Subjective** (*adjective*)

   _____

   _____

2. **Objective** (*adjective*)

   _____

   _____

3. **Bias** (*noun*)

   _____

   _____

Week 7 Reading Practice 2.1

Reading AC 2.1

Identifying the purpose of a text often requires an understanding what different verbs (and related adjectives) mean.

Here is a list of vocabulary that has appeared in exam papers related to purpose; however, please note that your actual exam may contain other words that don't appear here:

Verbs		Adjectives
Advertise	Instruct	Descriptive
Advise	Offer a rationale	Discursive
Argue	Outline	Expository
Encourage	Persuade	Factual
Evaluate	Praise	Fictional
Compare	Question	Informative
Complain	Review	Instructive
Criticise	Sell	Narrative
Describe	State	Non-fictional
Discuss	Suggest	Persuasive
Guide	Summarise	
Highlight	Train	
Inform	Warn	

Task: Use *adjectives* from the above list to identify the purpose of each paragraph below on the lines provided. Then, answer the additional questions that follow.

1. _____

The small village of Lucerne is nestled in a picturesque valley surrounded by towering mountains. The houses, with their charming wooden facades and colourful flowers in the windows, give the village a fairy-tale appearance. A crystal-clear river runs through the centre, where swans swim lazily. In the mornings, the village is often wrapped in a light mist, making it seem like a scene from a painting.

2. _____

Photosynthesis is the process by which green plants use sunlight to make their food. This process takes place in the chloroplasts of plant cells, which contain a green pigment called chlorophyll. Chlorophyll absorbs sunlight and uses its energy to convert carbon dioxide and water into glucose and oxygen. Photosynthesis is crucial for life on Earth because it produces the oxygen that most living organisms need to breathe.

3. _____

Wearing seat belts should be mandatory for everyone in a vehicle. Seat belts save lives by reducing the risk of injury during accidents. Statistics show that people who wear seat belts are much less likely to suffer severe injuries or death in car crashes. Additionally, wearing seat belts can prevent passengers from being thrown out of the vehicle, which is often fatal. Making seat belt use compulsory is a simple yet effective way to protect everyone on the road.

4. _____

Last summer, I went on an unforgettable adventure to the Amazon rainforest. We travelled by boat deep into the jungle, where we saw incredible wildlife, including monkeys, resplendent birds and even a jaguar. One night, we camped by the river and listened to the sounds of the forest. It was both thrilling and a little scary. The experience taught me the importance of preserving such natural wonders for future generations.

Task: Answer these additional questions

Paragraph 1

1. What is the main focus of paragraph 1?

_____

_____

2. How does the author create a vivid image of the village?

_____

_____

Paragraph 2

3. What process is being explained?

_____

4. Why is this process important for life on Earth?

_____

Paragraph 3

5. What is the author's main argument?

_____

6. What reasons does the author give to support the argument?

_____

Paragraph 4

7. What is the setting of the story?

_____

8. What emotions does the author describe feeling during the adventure?

_____

Task: Look at the wordsearch below. Search, find and highlight 15 verbs and adjectives from the <u>Purposes for Writing</u> vocabulary list.

Word Search Puzzle (15 Words)

J	X	Z	N	D	I	F	V	P	A	D	C	T	M	W	X	T	N	N	E
I	D	M	S	T	D	U	I	G	E	H	V	O	U	A	A	T	F	Y	P
C	O	O	V	I	W	P	J	S	I	R	F	X	P	E	W	U	N	F	R
G	Z	S	U	D	K	N	S	G	A	L	S	D	R	E	M	F	S	I	U
P	B	W	Z	O	O	H	H	Q	A	R	F	U	I	K	W	P	M	I	U
R	C	B	L	F	X	L	K	H	I	T	G	W	A	E	Y	A	Z	E	V
A	R	Q	C	N	I	Z	N	M	P	X	E	U	V	S	S	A	R	R	C
I	I	D	V	G	O	S	U	G	G	E	S	T	E	H	I	E	J	N	O
S	T	Y	H	O	T	Y	A	D	V	E	R	T	I	S	E	V	L	Q	W
E	I	T	X	A	A	R	D	P	U	Y	P	Y	H	H	W	U	E	L	L
I	C	Y	F	A	R	E	I	M	E	F	O	S	X	T	M	I	G	N	K
T	I	B	O	U	X	V	S	C	T	V	I	Z	V	P	P	S	P	Q	Q
X	S	F	Q	M	B	I	C	R	I	F	A	C	U	V	O	F	X	D	B
M	E	M	Z	O	U	E	U	L	S	P	Y	L	T	Y	P	S	O	G	V
V	B	C	M	I	D	W	R	Y	G	L	P	X	U	I	N	Y	R	J	X
X	Z	T	Z	I	U	R	S	S	N	U	P	P	H	A	O	S	I	U	E
V	F	V	B	H	D	U	I	D	U	K	I	F	X	B	T	N	S	V	B
C	C	U	J	Z	E	A	V	U	O	S	J	D	L	A	D	E	A	D	V
H	M	K	L	F	I	R	E	A	E	B	O	P	E	U	S	C	A	L	Y
J	I	H	I	N	S	T	R	U	C	T	I	V	E	T	X	S	O	M	B

The words included are:

- **FICTIONAL**
- **SUGGEST**
- **WARN**
- **EVALUATE**
- **CRITICISE**
- **PRAISE**
- **ARGUE**
- **REVIEW**
- **SELL**
- **HIGHLIGHT**
- **DISCURSIVE**
- **ADVERTISE**
- **PERSUASIVE**
- **GUIDE**
- **INSTRUCTIVE**

Week 8 Reading practice 3.2

Reading AC 3.2

A new reading skill at Level 2 is the ability to **evaluate information from different sources**.

For example, imagine a hiring committee in the HR (Human Resources) department at an organisation having to read through many CVs and cover letters. They are responsible for deciding on a short list of candidates to be selected for a job interview.

Task: Read the profiles of various job candidates on the next page and answer these questions.

b) Which candidate has international experience? _____

c) Which candidate is up to date with student life in academia? _____

d) Which candidate has received recognition for success in business? _____

e) Which candidate seems not to have any professional experience yet? _____

f) Which candidate is known for having domestic experience? _____

g) Which candidate can serve as mentor for a start-up company? _____

h) Which candidate might be keen to 'think globally but act locally'? _____

i) Which candidate is most likely to be hired for sales and marketing? _____

j) Which candidate is most likely to be involved in social enterprise? _____

k) Which candidate would be considered for an entry-level position? _____

l) Which candidate could be trusted with overseeing operations? _____

True or false:

m) Ashley can be described as meticulous in his work. _____

n) Gethin will need to catch up on the recent changes in his industry. _____

Alex Jones is a highly successful entrepreneur returning to the workforce after several years running her own business. Alex excels at business strategy, financial management and innovation. Her hands-on experience in building a business from the ground up has endowed her with exceptional leadership, adaptability and a results-oriented mindset. She is now seeking to bring her comprehensive skill set to a new role within an organisation. Known for her strategic vision, creativity and collaborative approach, Alex is eager to contribute to a forward-thinking team and help drive growth.

Vernesta Cyril is an ambitious recent graduate with a bachelor's degree in Business Administration from Cardiff University. During her academic career, Vernesta developed a strong foundation in business principles, including marketing, finance and project management. Her coursework and internship experiences have honed her analytical skills, as well as her ability to work effectively in team settings. Eager to apply her knowledge in a professional setting, she is enthusiastic about business with a drive to succeed, ready to make a positive impact in the world.

Ashley Williams is a dedicated and results-driven professional with over five years of experience in project management and team leadership. With a proven track record of delivering projects on time and within budget, Ashley excels in dynamic environments that need strategic planning, careful attention to detail and strong communication skills. Ashley is passionate about leveraging his expertise to drive success and continuous improvement. Known for his proactive approach and problem-solving abilities, he is committed to achieving excellence in every task he undertakes, making him a valuable asset to any team.

Lawrence Llewellyn-Bowen has returned to Wales after a transformative year of volunteering abroad with UNICEF. During his time overseas, Lawrence worked on various humanitarian projects, honing his skills in project management, cross-cultural communication and problem-solving. His experience has enriched his ability to adapt quickly, work collaboratively and lead initiatives that make a real difference. With a strong background in social work and community development, he is committed to using his global experience to benefit local communities by supporting those in need.

Gethin Jones is eager to re-enter the workforce after a fulfilling career break for paternity reasons. With over a decade of prior experience in operations management, Gethin has a proven track record of optimising processes, leading teams and improving efficiency. During his career break, Gethin kept up with industry

Charlotte Church is a highly motivated and versatile leader in sales with an award-winning background in marketing and digital communications. With over six years of experience creating innovative marketing strategies, Charlotte is exceptional at

developments via continuous learning, ensuring his skills and knowledge stayed current. Known for his strong leadership, communication abilities and work ethic, he is excited to bring his renewed energy and perspective to a team.	increasing brand awareness and customer engagement. Her strengths lie in content creation, social media management and data analysis. Charlotte is known for creativity, reliability and interpersonal skills, making her adept at collaborating with cross-functional teams and building client relationships. Passionate about staying ahead of industry trends, she brings fresh ideas and valuable insights to any company.

Week 9 Reading Practice: Exam Overview

In preparation for the reading exam, let's have a closer look at how it works, what type of questions you may be asked and what you need to do. As you may remember, in order to pass you must achieve both an overall pass mark of 14/21 AND at least one correct answer for each of the assessment criteria.

After sitting a practice paper, pay close attention when checking the result by taking note of which types of questions you answered correctly or incorrectly.

If you see a trend in the errors, you should focus on those assessment

1.1	Identify the main points of text
1.2	Identify the main events of text
1.3	Use language features to identify meaning in text
1.4	Identify the meaning of vocabulary in text
2.1	Identify the purpose of text
3.1	Obtain specific information from text
3.2	Evaluate information from different sources

Question	Assessment Criteria	Tick if achieved
1	1.2	
2	1.3	
3	1.4	
4	3.1	
5	3.2	
Total Marks /5		

Besides the different question types above, questions can also be structured in a variety of ways:

Multiple choice

5 When communicating with people with hearing loss, you should: **Tick one box ☑**

a speak in a loud voice ☐

b wave at them all the time ☐

c repeat everything you say ☐

d try to speak as you usually would ☐

True or false

3 The use of English internationally has resulted in the advance of communications technology and economic globalisation. **Tick one box ☑**

True ☐

False ☐

Paragraph number

1 The text has 6 numbered paragraphs. Each paragraph has a main topic. Choose the most suitable heading for paragraphs 3, 4 and 5.

Display of Merchandise	
Control and Care of Merchandise	
Security of Merchandise	

Sequence

4 Put the following instructions in the correct order.

Register to use the EHIC Services website.	1
Apply for additional cards for family members.	
Log in to the EHIC Services website on the internet.	
Check your Spam folder for an email from the NHS.	
Activate your account by copying and pasting information.	

Open writing

4 Who holds a neutral view?

_____

Here are some tips for how to approach the open writing questions:

- **read the questions carefully**
- **write only what is required (one word = one word)**
- **don't overwrite - be clear and specific (as too much info might actually lose the mark)**
- **essential words only - sentences are not needed**
- **spelling, grammar etc. doesn't matter so long as answer is legible enough to be understood**
- **base answers on evidence found in the actual text**

Reading techniques: skimming, scanning and close reading

Skimming is reading rapidly in order to get the gist of the text. There are three types of skimming: preview, overview and review.

Scanning is reading rapidly in order to find specific facts. While skimming tells you what general information is within a section, scanning helps you locate a particular fact.

Close reading is a very in-depth, careful analysis of a short text.

Task: On the next page, there are three texts. (Don't look yet!)

Skimming task: Turn to the page and skim over the three texts for 15 seconds only. That's five seconds for each text. Then, return quickly back to this page and answer the questions below:

Text 1

1. *What kind of text is it?*

☐ Email ☐ Review ☐ Blog ☐ Advertisement

1. What is the text about?

_____

Text 2

1. What kind of text is it?

☐ Email ☐ Review ☐ Blog ☐ Advertisement

2. What is the text about?

_____

Text 3

1. What kind of text is it?

☐ Email ☐ Review ☐ Blog ☐ Advertisement

2. What is the text about?

_____

Text 1

Carpenter

Harper Construction Recruitment · 2.9 ★

Cardiff

£22 an hour - Full-time, Temporary contract

Full job description

We are looking for a **Carpenter** to start **Monday 22 July 2024** on a site in **Cardiff.**

This role comprises of fitting aluminium brackets to external walls, so the ideal candidate will have cladding experience as well as mast climbing experience.

Candidates must have a valid CSCS card.

If available & interested in this role, please **apply,** call the office on **01275 873664** or WhatsApp **07704 905880.**

Job Type: Temporary contract
Contract length: 2 Weeks

Text 2

Ask for a raise

Dear [Name of Manager/supervisor],

I have greatly enjoyed working for [company name] over the last 3 years. During these years, I feel that I have become a valuable member of your team and I have contributed to projects in a significant way.

Since working here, I have accomplished: [list accomplishments].

As an employee, I think I have outperformed the goals set for me. As a result, I would like to have the opportunity to discuss increasing my salary so that it matches my current performance. Please let me know when is a good time for you to meet so that we can discuss this further.

Once again, I am grateful to be part of an organization that provides me with unique challenges and opportunities to continuously learn and grow.

Best regards,

[Your name]

Text 3

MS **Matthew Simpson**
3 reviews AU

★★★★★ Invited A day ago

The Light in the Box Shone Brightly

It was great online shopping experience with a huge variety of what could be amazingly crafted products and some questionable ones. I will have to wait for the five items I ordered to arrive to give a proper review, but it's kind of like an online "thrift shop" except the items are brand new .... LightInTheBox seems to have a little bit of everything. I will be a returning customer.

Date of experience: 16 July 2024

Task: Scanning & close reading: Don't read the next text before you read these questions.

1. List three methods of sustainable transportation mentioned.

_____

2. What are two ways to manage energy consumption sustainably?

_____

3. How does diet affect sustainable living?

_____

4. What are three practices to reduce waste?

_____

5. Why is community involvement important in sustainable living?

_____

Sustainable living is a lifestyle that aims to reduce an individual's or society's use of the Earth's natural resources. People who practise sustainable living try to reduce their carbon footprint by altering methods of transportation, energy consumption and diet.

One major way to live sustainably is by choosing eco-friendly transportation methods. This includes walking, cycling, using public transport and driving electric or hybrid cars. Reducing the number of cars on the road decreases pollution and conserves fuel.

Another crucial aspect of sustainable living is managing energy consumption. Simple actions like using energy-efficient appliances, installing solar panels, and turning off lights when not in use can make a significant difference. These practices help lower electricity bills and reduce greenhouse gas emissions.

Diet also plays a significant role in sustainable living. Consuming locally-sourced, organic food reduces the carbon footprint associated with transporting food over long distances. Additionally, reducing meat consumption can significantly decrease greenhouse gas emissions, as livestock farming is a major contributor to methane production.

Reducing waste is another essential component of sustainable living. This can be achieved through recycling, composting and reducing the use of single-use plastics. By minimising waste, we can decrease the amount of garbage that ends up in landfills and oceans.

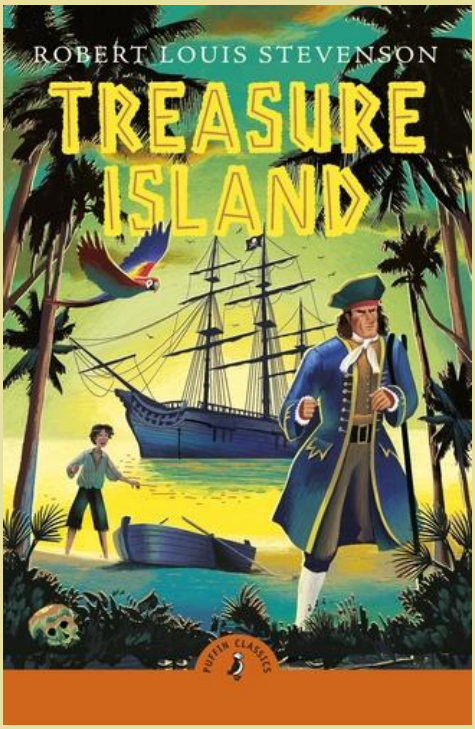
Sustainable living is not just about individual actions; community involvement is equally important. Participating in community gardens, local clean-up events and sustainability workshops can foster a collective effort towards a more sustainable future.

In conclusion, sustainable living involves making mindful choices in transportation, energy use, diet and waste management. By adopting these practices, individuals can contribute to a healthier planet and a sustainable future.

Week 10 Reading Practice

Task: In these texts, you will find words you don't know. Answer the questions as best you can!

You are going to read an extract from the 19th-century novel *Treasure Island*, in which the narrator describes his first meeting with one of the main characters. For questions 1-6 choose the answer (A, B, C or D) which you think fits best according to the text.



Squire Trelawney, Dr. Livesey, and the rest of these gentlemen asked me to write down the whole story about Treasure Island, from the beginning to the end, keeping nothing back but the location of the island, and that only because there the treasure is still there. I take up my pen and go back to the time when my father kept the Admiral Benbow inn and the brown old seaman with the scar first came to stay under our roof.

I remember him as if it were yesterday, as he came up to the inn door, his luggage following behind him in a **barrow**—a tall, strong, heavy, nut-brown man, his pigtail falling over the shoulder of his soiled blue coat, his hands ragged and scarred, with black, broken nails, and the sabre cut across one cheek, a dirty white. I remember him looking round the bay and whistling to himself as he **did so**, and then breaking out in an old sea-song and knocking on the door with a bit of stick that he carried, and when my father appeared, calling roughly for a drink. This, when it was brought to him, he drank slowly, and looked about him at the cliffs and up at our signboard.

"This is a handy bay," he said; "and a pleasant place to stay. Is there much company, mate?"

My father told him no, very few customers, unfortunately.

"Well, then," said he, "this is the place for me. Here you," he cried to the man who had pushed the barrow; "Unload my chest. I'll stay here a bit," he continued. "I'm a plain man; bacon and eggs are what I want, and that head up there to watch the ships. You can call me captain."

And indeed, bad as his clothes were and roughly as he spoke, he had none of the appearance of a

sailor, but seemed like an officer or mate, used to being obeyed. The man who came with the barrow told us he had arrived the morning before at the Royal George, that he had inquired what inns there were along the coast, and hearing ours well-spoken of, I suppose, and described as lonely, had chosen it from the others for his place of residence. And that was all we could learn of our guest.

He was a very silent man. All day he hung round the bay or upon the cliffs with a brass telescope; all evening he sat in a corner next to the fire. Mostly he would not speak when spoken to, only look up suddenly and fiercely; and we and the people who came to our house soon learned to let him be. Every day when he came back from his stroll he would ask if any sailors had gone by along the road. At first, we thought it was the lack of company of his own kind that made him ask this question, but at last we began to see he was keen to avoid them. When a seaman did stay at the Admiral Benbow (as now and then some did, making by the coast road for Bristol) he would look in at him through the curtained door before he entered the room; and he was always sure to be as silent as a mouse when any such person was present.

I took an interest in these sailors as well, because he had promised me a silver fourpenny on the first of every month if I would only keep my "eyes open for a sailor with one leg" and let him know the moment he appeared. Often enough when the first of the month came round and I applied to him for my wage, he would only stare me down, but before the week was out, he was sure to think better of it, bring me my four-penny piece, and repeat his orders to look out for "the sailor with one leg."

1. Why is the narrator recording these events?

a. to ask other people for help in finding the treasure

b. to help him remember what happened a long time ago

c. to respond to a request from people he knows

d. to share important information about the treasure with other people

2. In the second paragraph, what is the meaning of the word '*barrow*'?

a. a particular area

b. a short time

c. a type of profession

d. a vehicle

3. What does '*did so*' refer to in the second paragraph?

a. arriving at the inn

b. checking the surroundings

c. knocking on the door

d. whistling to himself

4. Why did the man decide to stay at this place?

a. He liked the staff.

b. It was cheap.

c. It was remote with few people.

d. The food was good.

5. Why did the man ask if anyone had seen other sailors?

a. He wanted to avoid sailors.

b. He disliked sailors in general.

c. He was lonely and wanted some company.

d. He wasn't a real sailor himself.

6. How did the man feel about paying the narrator?

a. He always paid him on time.

b. He would change his mind.

c. He complained about paying him.

d. He never paid him.

Task: You are going to read about five unusual racquet sports. For questions 13-20, choose from the sections A-E. The sections may be chosen more than once.

Special sports

Five unusual racquet sports that you might want to try

A. Pickleball may have a funny name, but it's a serious sport that has 2.8 million active players in the United States alone. It was invented by Joel Pritchard, a Washington state father, to entertain a bored teenager on vacation, using homemade items and equipment taken from other sports. The game is a combination of badminton, table tennis and tennis. Players hit a light plastic ball over a low net on a small court. The game only requires half of the area of a tennis court, and you can play on any type of surface, indoor or outdoor, winter or summer. Pickleball quickly became popular with the Pritchards' friends and neighbours, and it continued to spread farther afield through word-of-mouth. Pickleball sets have been commercially available since 1972. However, it was thanks to the Internet that the game really took off. Since 2010, there has been a 385% increase in the number of pickleball courts worldwide.

B. In 1969, Mexican businessman Enrique Concuera decided to have his home squash court remodelled in a unique way, which included some features of another game called platform tennis. He named the new game Padel. Visiting friends fell in love with the new sport, and in the mid-1970s, padel was exported to Spain and Argentina with the rules adapted to make play more competitive. Since then, padel has been a firm favourite throughout the Spanish-speaking world, but is also popular in Italy, France and the USA. Padel is always played as doubles, so there are four people on the enclosed court for every game. Players use a short solid racquet to hit a tennis-like ball over a central net. The scoring is the same as for tennis. International championships have been taking place regularly since 2005, and there are hopes that the sport might one day be included in the Olympics.

C. If you could go back to the time of King Henry VIII, you would find people playing a game that reminded you a lot of tennis. In fact, it was tennis, real tennis, the ancestor of the modern game, and popular in royal households in both England and France during the 16th and 17th centuries. Real tennis is played on an indoor walled court, with players using pear shaped racquets to hit a very hard and very heavy ball made of cloth across a net. Today, it is played in England, France, Australia and the USA, but there are only forty real tennis courts in the world. They are difficult and expensive to build, and as the number of players is decreasing, the game is in a state of decline. This is a shame because it's a fast-paced and thrilling sport. However, if you visit Henry VIII's palace at Hampton Court, just outside central London, you can still see where he played real tennis.

D. The Basque people, who live along the Spanish-French border, practise a shared culture famous for its ancient language, delicious food, and the sport of pelota. In fact, pelota is not just one sport but a family of related ball games, all played against a wall. You can play singles, doubles or even in teams, but it's the incredible variety of game play which really stands out. In some versions of pelota, players hit the rubber ball with a racquet, but other versions involve using gloves or bare hands, and one even uses a basket to catch the ball. It has been described as the fastest game on earth. Pelota has origins in the sports of ancient Greece and most Basque villages have a court for residents to play, often attached to the local church. In 1900, pelota featured in the Paris Olympic games, but despite being popular in South America, the Philippines and the USA, it has not been included as an official Olympic sport since then.

E. Not all racquet games are played on a court. Stoolball, which later developed into the games of cricket and baseball, is played on a village green, an open grassy space at the centre of some villages in England. Players use a racquet shaped like a long table tennis paddle to defend upright posts called wickets from a ball. The game is challenging because the field is not level so players must run carefully between wickets or to catch the ball. The name comes from the fact that early versions of the sport had players defending stools (items of furniture like chairs, but without backs). Another unusual feature of the game is that teams are composed of male and female players of any age - truly an activity for the whole village to enjoy. There is evidence that stoolball was played as early as the 15th century, but only in the southeastern counties of England. People still enjoy the game in this area today.

Which paragraph ...

13. suggests that players would like to develop the sport further?

14. expresses some sadness about the sport's future?

15. states that the sport includes features of three different games?

16. explains the origins of two modern sports?

17. describes a common sports facility provided for the use of local people?

18. says that the sport's most unusual feature is how it can be played?

19. describes a sport that always includes a large number of players?

20. describes how technology has led to a change in the sport's popularity?

Week 11 Extra Reading Practice

Task: Read the following text and answer the questions below.

Text: The Revival of Welsh Music

Over the past few decades, Welsh music has seen a powerful revival. From traditional folk songs sung in the Welsh language to contemporary rock and pop bands, Wales continues to make a unique contribution to the music scene both locally and internationally.

Historically known as the "Land of Song," Wales has a rich musical heritage. Male voice choirs, harp music, and folk tunes have long been part of Welsh culture, especially in rural areas. In the past, music was often performed at **eisteddfodau**—traditional festivals that celebrate poetry, music, and performance. These events remain popular today and encourage the preservation of the Welsh language and culture.

In more recent years, new Welsh artists have emerged with music that blends traditional sounds with modern genres. Bands like **Super Furry Animals** and **Catatonia** became famous in the 1990s, combining rock music with Welsh identity. Meanwhile, artists such as **Gwenno**, who sings in Welsh and Cornish, have brought Celtic languages to new audiences.

The Welsh government and cultural organisations have invested in music education and events to support young musicians. Music festivals like the **Green Man Festival** and **Festival Interceltique** have played a key role in promoting Welsh talent alongside international artists.

Welsh music is not just about entertainment; it is also a symbol of identity and pride. As more people show interest in learning Welsh, music continues to play an important part in keeping the language alive.

Assessment Criterion 1.1 – Identify the main point of the text

1. What is the main focus of the text?
   a) The popularity of English pop music in Wales
   b) The history of British music festivals
   c) The revival and importance of Welsh music
   d) The success of Welsh food and drink industry

Assessment Criterion 1.2 – Identify the main events of the text

2. Which of the following is mentioned as a traditional Welsh music event?
   a) Glastonbury Festival
   b) The Proms
   c) Eisteddfodau
   d) Eurovision

3. What happened in the 1990s in Welsh music?
   a) The Welsh language was banned from songs
   b) Artists began using only traditional instruments
   c) Famous Welsh rock bands became popular
   d) Welsh choirs stopped performing

Assessment Criterion 1.3 – Use language features to identify meaning in text

4. What does the phrase *"Land of Song"* suggest about Wales?
   a) Wales is a place with a lot of rain
   b) Music is an important part of Welsh identity
   c) People do not listen to music in Wales
   d) Only traditional songs are allowed in Wales

5. Why is the word *eisteddfodau* written in italics?
   a) To show it is a mistake
   b) Because it is a Welsh word unfamiliar to English readers
   c) To indicate it is an English name
   d) To highlight it is not important

Assessment Criterion 1.4 – Identify the meaning of vocabulary in text

6. What does the word *revival* most likely mean in the first paragraph?
   a) A type of music
   b) A decline or decrease
   c) A return to popularity or renewed interest
   d) A religious ceremony

7. What is the closest meaning to *heritage* in the second paragraph?
   a) Fashion
   b) Tradition and culture passed down
   c) Holiday
   d) Technology

Assessment Criterion 3.1 – Obtain specific information from text

8. Name two Welsh music festivals mentioned in the text. _____

9. Which artist sings in both Welsh and Cornish? _____

Week 12 Extra Reading Practice

Task: Read the following text and answer the questions below:

Text: The Changing Face of British Food

British food has changed dramatically over the last fifty years. Once known for simple dishes like roast beef and fish and chips, modern British cuisine is now influenced by flavours from around the world. Immigration, travel, and global trade have all helped to shape the way people in Britain eat today.

In the past, British meals were often based on meat and vegetables, with traditional recipes passed down through families. Dishes like shepherd's pie, Cornish pasties, and Yorkshire pudding were common in many homes. While these meals are still popular, the British diet has become more varied and adventurous. Today, many people enjoy food from different cultures. Indian curries, Chinese stir-fries, Italian pasta dishes, and Middle Eastern kebabs are now part of everyday life in the UK. Supermarkets and restaurants offer a huge range of international ingredients and meals, making it easier for people to cook and try new things.

Health and sustainability are also becoming more important to British consumers. More people are choosing to eat less meat or switch to plant-based diets. Farmers' markets and organic food shops have become more common, and there is growing interest in where food comes from and how it is produced.

Despite these changes, traditional British food still plays a role in national celebrations. Afternoon tea, full English breakfasts, and Christmas dinners remain strong symbols of British identity.

Reading Comprehension Questions

Assessment Criterion 1.1 – Identify the main point of the text

1. What is the main purpose of this text?
   a) To explain how to cook traditional British food
   b) To describe the problems with British farming
   c) To show how British food has changed over time
   d) To compare British food with French food

Assessment Criterion 1.2 – Identify the main events of the text

2. Which foods were common in traditional British homes?
   a) Pizza and pasta
   b) Roast beef and Cornish pasties
   c) Sushi and tofu
   d) Tacos and burritos

3. What recent changes in eating habits are mentioned in the text?
   a) People only eat fast food
   b) People are cooking less
   c) More people are choosing plant-based diets
   d) Traditional food is no longer available

Assessment Criterion 1.3 – Use language features to identify meaning in text

4. What does the phrase *"the British diet has become more varied and adventurous"* suggest?
   a) People are eating less food
   b) People are trying new types of food from different cultures
   c) British food is now boring
   d) Food in the UK is more expensive

5. Why does the writer use the phrase *"Changing face of British food"* in the title?
   a) To show food is disappearing
   b) To suggest British food is now global and modern
   c) To say food looks different
   d) To describe the faces of British chefs

Assessment Criterion 1.4 – Identify the meaning of vocabulary in text

6. What does the word *sustainability* most likely mean in the fourth paragraph?
   a) Cooking with expensive ingredients
   b) The ability to grow and produce food in a way that does not harm the planet

c) Buying food in large amounts
d) Wasting less time on shopping

7. What is the meaning of *adventurous* in paragraph 2?
   a) Risky or dangerous
   b) Boring and traditional
   c) Willing to try new or exciting things
   d) Tired of cooking

Assessment Criterion 3.1 – Obtain specific information from text

8. Name **three** international cuisines mentioned in the text.

   _____

   _____

   _____

9. What are two traditional British meals mentioned that are still popular today?

   _____ _____

Week 13 Extra Reading Practice

Task: Read the text and answer the questions below.

Britpop – The Sound of the 1990s

In the early 1990s, a new style of British music exploded onto the scene. Known as **Britpop**, it was more than just music – it became a cultural movement that defined a generation. The Britpop era was all about confidence, identity, and a return to British guitar bands.

Britpop developed as a reaction against American grunge music, which was popular at the time. Instead of dark, emotional lyrics, Britpop bands wrote songs that were catchy, upbeat, and often focused on everyday British life. The lyrics were full of humour, irony, and references to working-class culture.

Two of the biggest bands in the Britpop scene were **Oasis** and **Blur**. Their rivalry was famously known as the "Battle of Britpop." In 1995, both bands released singles on the same day, and the media made it into

a national competition. Blur's "Country House" reached number one, beating Oasis's "Roll With It." However, both bands went on to enjoy huge success.

Other popular Britpop artists included **Pulp**, **Suede**, and **Elastica**. These bands helped to shape the sound and look of the decade. Britpop influenced fashion, politics, and even national pride. The term **"Cool Britannia"** was often used to describe the optimistic mood in the country at the time.

By the late 1990s, Britpop began to fade as new styles of music took over. However, its impact on British culture and music history remains strong. Even today, many people look back on Britpop as a golden age for British music.

Reading Comprehension Questions

Assessment Criterion 1.1 – Identify the main point of the text

1. What is the main idea of the text?
   a) How American music influenced British bands
   b) A description of British politics in the 1990s
   c) The rise and influence of Britpop in the 1990s
   d) Why Oasis was more popular than Blur

Assessment Criterion 1.2 – Identify the main events of the text

2. What major event happened in 1995 related to Britpop?
   a) Oasis and Blur recorded an album together
   b) Pulp won a national music award
   c) Blur and Oasis released singles on the same day
   d) Britpop became popular in the United States

3. What happened to Britpop by the end of the 1990s?
   a) It became more popular
   b) It was replaced by new music styles
   c) It spread to Asia
   d) It turned into classical music

Assessment Criterion 1.3 – Use language features to identify meaning in text

4. What does the phrase *"Battle of Britpop"* suggest about the relationship between Oasis and Blur?
   a) They were close friends

b) They refused to play live
c) They competed with each other
d) They were in the same band

5. What effect does the phrase *"golden age for British music"* have on the reader?
   a) It shows Britpop was not very important
   b) It suggests the time was boring
   c) It highlights that Britpop was a special and successful time in music
   d) It means Britpop lasted for 100 years

Assessment Criterion 1.4 – Identify the meaning of vocabulary in text

6. What does *upbeat* mean in paragraph 2?
   a) Sad and emotional
   b) Fast and aggressive
   c) Positive and energetic
   d) Long and complicated

7. What is the meaning of *influenced* in paragraph 4?
   a) Ignored or avoided
   b) Changed or affected something
   c) Played music
   d) Watched something on TV

Assessment Criterion 3.1 – Obtain specific information from text

8. Name two bands mentioned in the text that were part of the Britpop movement.

9. What was the name of the Blur song that beat Oasis's single in the charts?

Week 14 Extra Reading Practice

Task: Read the text and answer the questions below.

Unusual British Festivals and Celebrations

When people think of British celebrations, they often imagine royal weddings, afternoon tea, or Christmas crackers. However, Britain is also home to a number of unusual and quirky festivals that surprise and entertain visitors from around the world. These events often reflect local traditions, a strong sense of community, and a great sense of humour.

One of the most famous unusual events is the **World Bog Snorkelling Championship**, held every August in Llanwrtyd Wells, Wales. Participants wear snorkels, flippers, and often fancy dress as they race through a 60-yard trench cut into a peat bog. The goal is to swim the length of the bog as fast as possible without using traditional swimming strokes. The event began in 1976 as a way to attract tourists, and it has since become internationally famous. People from all over the world travel to take part or cheer on the swimmers.

Another unusual British tradition is **Cheese Rolling** in Gloucestershire. Every spring, a large wheel of cheese is rolled down a very steep hill, and dozens of people chase after it. The first person to reach the bottom wins the cheese. Despite the risk of injury, the event is hugely popular and has been going on for hundreds of years. Some people believe it may have started as part of a pagan fertility ritual.

In Ottery St Mary, Devon, the **Tar Barrel Festival** takes place every November. Locals carry large wooden barrels filled with burning tar through the streets of the town. The barrels are lit and placed on people's backs, and they run with them through the crowds. It's a dangerous but exciting event that has been part of the town's culture for centuries. Only people born in the town are allowed to carry the barrels. These unusual celebrations may seem strange to outsiders, but they play an important role in local identity and tradition. They bring people together, attract visitors, and remind everyone that British culture is full of surprises.

Reading Comprehension Questions

1.1 – Identify the main point of the text

1. What is the main purpose of this text?
   a) To explain how to snorkel in a bog
   b) To describe British food festivals
   c) To inform readers about unusual British celebrations
   d) To compare British and American sports

1.2 – Identify the main events of the text

2. What do participants in bog snorkeling wear?
   a) Swimsuits and goggles
   b) Snorkels, flippers, and fancy dress
   c) Wetsuits and helmets
   d) Life jackets and diving suits

3. What happens at the Tar Barrel Festival?
   a) People cook food in barrels
   b) People roll cheese down a hill
   c) People carry burning barrels through the town
   d) People build barrels from tar

1.3 – Use language features to identify meaning in text

4. What does the phrase *"a strong sense of community"* suggest about the people who attend these festivals?
   a) They are competitive
   b) They care about tradition and each other
   c) They don't enjoy working together
   d) They are all related

5. Why is the word **only** used in the sentence *"Only people born in the town are allowed to carry the barrels"*?
   a) To show a safety rule
   b) To express pride in local tradition
   c) To limit who can take part
   d) To encourage tourists to try it

1.4 – Identify the meaning of vocabulary in text

6. What is the meaning of *quirky* in the first paragraph?
   a) Expensive or luxurious
   b) Strange in an interesting or fun way
   c) Boring or repetitive
   d) Traditional and serious

7. What does the word *participants* mean in paragraph two?
   a) People who organise the event
   b) People who watch the event
   c) People who take part in the event
   d) Journalists who report the event

3.1 – Obtain specific information from text

8. How long is the bog snorkelling course?

9. What prize do you win at the cheese rolling event?

Week 15 Extra Reading Practice

Text: The History of Tiger Bay – Cardiff's Multicultural Heart

Tiger Bay is one of the most famous and historically important areas of Cardiff, the capital of Wales. Located near the docks, Tiger Bay played a key role in Cardiff's development as a major port city during the 19th and early 20th centuries. It became known for its vibrant multicultural community, which included people from over 50 different nationalities.

In the late 1800s and early 1900s, Cardiff was one of the busiest coal-exporting ports in the world. Ships from across the globe came to the Cardiff Docks to collect coal from Welsh mines. As a result, workers and sailors from Africa, the Caribbean, the Middle East, and Asia began to settle in the area. Many of them married local people and raised families. The community that developed became known as Tiger Bay, though its official name was Butetown.

Tiger Bay was not always easy to live in. The area was poor, and people often faced discrimination. However, despite the challenges, it was also a place full of life, culture, and music. Tiger Bay

became famous for its jazz musicians, cafes, and social clubs. Communities supported each other, and there was a strong sense of belonging.

In the 1960s and 70s, many of the old buildings were knocked down as part of redevelopment. The government wanted to modernise the area, but this meant that much of the original community was lost or moved away. In the 1990s, the Cardiff Bay area was transformed again, with new homes, shops, and tourist attractions. Today, few original buildings remain, but efforts have been made to remember Tiger Bay's history.

One of the most famous people from Tiger Bay is singer Shirley Bassey, who grew up in the area. She later became an international star, best known for singing James Bond theme songs. Her story reflects the rich culture and talent that grew in Tiger Bay.

Although the name "Tiger Bay" is no longer used officially, it still lives on in the memories of the people who lived there. The history of Tiger Bay is a story of struggle, diversity, and strength – a reminder of how immigration and community helped shape modern Cardiff.

Reading Comprehension Questions

1.1 – Identify the main point of the text

1. What is the main purpose of this text?
   a) To explain how coal was exported from Wales
   b) To describe the architecture of Cardiff Bay
   c) To tell the story of Tiger Bay and its multicultural community
   d) To promote tourism in Wales

1.2 – Identify the main events of the text

2. Why did people from many different countries settle in Tiger Bay?
   a) They were escaping war
   b) They came to work in Cardiff's coal-exporting docks
   c) They wanted to open shops
   d) They were invited by the Welsh government

3. What happened to Tiger Bay in the 1960s and 70s?
   a) It became a popular tourist destination
   b) Many buildings were destroyed and the community was changed
   c) The docks closed permanently
   d) It was renamed Cardiff Central

1.3 – Use language features to identify meaning

4. What does the phrase *"full of life, culture, and music"* suggest about Tiger Bay?
   a) It was noisy and unpleasant
   b) It was a lively and vibrant place to live
   c) It was quiet and peaceful
   d) It had very few people

5. What effect does the phrase *"a story of struggle, diversity, and strength"* have on the reader?
   a) It encourages sympathy for Cardiff
   b) It shows that Tiger Bay was weak
   c) It highlights pride in the community's history
   d) It means Tiger Bay no longer exists

1.4 – Identify the meaning of vocabulary in text

6. What does *multicultural* mean in paragraph one?
   a) A place with one religion
   b) A place with people from many different cultures
   c) A traditional Welsh town
   d) A farming village

7. What does *redevelopment* mean in paragraph four?
   a) Cleaning the streets
   b) Making the area poorer
   c) Building new homes and shops
   d) Moving people out permanently

3.1 – Obtain specific information from text

8. What kind of music was Tiger Bay known for?

9. Name one famous person who came from Tiger Bay.

Week 16 Extra Reading Practice

Task: Read the following online discussion about a popular British soap opera (Coronation Street) and answer the questions below.

Topic: Is Coronation Street still worth watching in 2025?

User1 – SoapFan88
I've been watching *Corrie* since I was a teenager in the 90s, and I still watch it now. Sure, it's changed over the years, but so has everything else. I like that it still covers real-life issues – recently there was a storyline about gambling addiction that was really powerful. The acting is solid, and I appreciate the mix of drama and humour. It's not perfect, but it's still one of the best soaps out there.

User2 – CorrieCritic2025
Honestly, I think it's lost its way. The writing has become lazy, and they seem more focused on shock value than believable stories. Last month they had three characters die in one week – it felt like something from a movie, not a soap set in a small street in Manchester. I miss the days when it was more about ordinary people and their everyday struggles.

User3 – NewbieWatcher
I only started watching during lockdown and now I'm hooked! I didn't grow up with it, but I love the drama. I think the newer episodes are fast-paced and exciting, and it doesn't matter if it's unrealistic – it's entertainment! Also, the newer characters are more diverse and relatable for younger viewers like me.

User4 – OldSchoolCorrie
I agree with CorrieCritic2025. The show used to have heart. I remember the humour of characters like Blanche or the warmth of the old corner shop scenes. Now it feels too serious or too dramatic. I stopped watching last year because I didn't recognise the show anymore.

User5 – MediaTeacherAlex
From a media perspective, I think *Coronation Street* is trying to stay relevant in a competitive world of streaming and binge-worthy dramas. They're adding more dramatic twists to keep people watching. It's a challenge – stay traditional and risk being called boring or evolve and risk losing long-time fans. I think they're doing their best to balance both.

(Assessment Criterion 3.2 – Evaluate Information from Different Sources)

1. Which two users believe the show has changed in a negative way? What specific reasons do they give?

_____

2. **Which user defends the show's decision to include more dramatic or fast-paced storylines? What is their main argument?**

_____

3. **Who values the realism of the older episodes, and what do they say is missing in the current version of the show?**

_____

4. **Which user talks about the show from an analytical or professional point of view? How is their opinion different from the others'?**

_____

5. **Compare User1 and User2's views. What do they agree on, and how do their opinions differ?**

_____

6. **Do any of the users mention how the show appeals to younger or newer viewers? What do they say?**

_____

7. Based on all the comments, do you think the show is more popular with older fans or newer fans? Give reasons from the text.

_____

_____

_____

_____

Week 17 Extra Reading Practice

Task: Read the following text and answer the questions below:

Why Do British People Love Garden Centres?

In recent years, garden centres have become one of the UK's most popular places to visit during weekends and holidays. Once mainly used by keen gardeners to buy plants and tools, today's garden centres offer far more than pots and compost. They've transformed into leisure destinations where people go to relax, shop, eat, and even socialise.

Many people describe garden centres as peaceful and stress-free. Surrounded by colourful flowers and gentle background music, visitors often say it's like "a little escape from the world." Some centres even have small ponds, wildlife areas, or butterfly gardens. These natural settings can help people feel calm and refreshed, especially after a busy week.

Food is another reason people flock to garden centres. Most now include cafés or restaurants that serve homemade cakes, afternoon teas, and Sunday roasts. For some, it's the main reason to go. Retired couples, families with children, and groups of friends often meet there for a bite to eat. You don't have to love gardening to enjoy a cream tea and a chat.

Garden centres are also ideal for browsing. They usually sell more than just plants. Customers can find home décor, books, clothing, candles, and even pet supplies. At Christmas, many centres are transformed into magical winter wonderlands with lights, decorations, and Santa's grotto. In fact, for some, a garden centre visit has become part of their annual festive tradition.

There are also practical reasons for their popularity. Garden centres are usually located just outside towns or in rural areas, meaning there is often free parking and less traffic. The open space makes them accessible for people with mobility needs or prams. Dogs are often welcome too, which adds to the relaxed and friendly atmosphere.

Some people criticise garden centres for being too expensive. It's true that prices can be higher than supermarkets or online shops, especially for plants and furniture. Others say that some centres have lost their original purpose – to help people garden – and focus too much on lifestyle and profit.

Despite this, garden centres continue to grow in popularity. For many British people, they offer more than shopping: they provide a slow-paced, welcoming environment that suits a wide range of visitors. Whether you're there for petunias or pastries, it's clear that garden centres have become part of British leisure culture.

1.1 – Identify the main point of the text

1. What is the main purpose of this text?
   a) To explain how to grow plants at home
   b) To describe why garden centres have become popular in the UK
   c) To compare garden centres in the UK and abroad
   d) To show the history of British gardening

1.2 – Identify the main events / ideas

2. List **three** reasons why people visit garden centres, according to the text.

3. What do some people do at garden centres at Christmas time?

1.3 – Use language features to identify meaning

4. What does the phrase *"a little escape from the world"* suggest about how visitors feel at garden centres?
   a) They are bored
   b) They feel relaxed and away from stress
   c) They are confused
   d) They are trying to hide

5. The phrase *"flock to garden centres"* uses imagery. What does it suggest?
   a) People arrive in large numbers, like birds
   b) People fly to the garden centre
   c) Only animal lovers go
   d) People are quiet and gentle

1.4 – Identify the meaning of vocabulary

6. What does *leisure destinations* mean in paragraph 1?
   a) Places for working
   b) Places for relaxing and enjoyment

c) Holiday companies
d) Shops that sell gardening tools

7. What does *browsing* mean in paragraph 4?
   a) Looking around without the intention to buy anything immediately
   b) Buying expensive items quickly
   c) Reading a book
   d) Using the internet

3.1 – Obtain specific information

8. Name **two** types of food that are mentioned as popular in garden centre cafés.

---

9. Give **one** reason why garden centres are accessible for people with mobility issues.

3.2 – Evaluate information from different sources

10. According to the text, what are the **positive opinions** people have about garden centres?

---

11. What are the **criticisms** some people have about garden centres?

Week 18 Extra Reading Practice

Task: Read about the history of this famous town in South Wales and answer the questions below:

A Short History of Merthyr Tydfil

Merthyr Tydfil is a town in South Wales with a rich industrial past. Once the largest town in Wales, it played a key role in the Industrial Revolution. Today, it is known for its history, stunning nearby countryside, and efforts to grow after the decline of heavy industry.

The town is named after Saint Tydfil, who, according to legend, was a Christian martyr killed in the 5th century. The Welsh word *merthyr* means "martyr", and the name honours her memory. For many years, Merthyr was a small, quiet village. However, everything changed in the late 18th century.

In the 1700s and 1800s, Merthyr became a major centre for iron production. The discovery of iron ore, coal, and limestone in the area helped fuel this growth. The town's four great ironworks – Dowlais, Cyfarthfa, Plymouth, and Penydarren – attracted thousands of workers from across Wales and beyond. The population increased rapidly, and Merthyr became a busy, noisy industrial town full of smoke, fire, and steam.

The iron industry also brought innovation. In 1804, engineer Richard Trevithick tested the world's first steam-powered railway locomotive at Penydarren. This event is considered one of the most important moments in the history of transport.

Merthyr was not only important for industry but also for workers' rights. In 1831, poor working conditions and rising food prices led to the Merthyr Rising, a major protest by workers. It ended violently when soldiers were sent in, and a man named Dic Penderyn was hanged for his role. Many people still believe he was innocent. Today, he is remembered as a hero who stood up for justice.

By the late 1800s, the iron industry started to decline, and coal mining became the main industry. Merthyr remained an important town, but after the coal industry collapsed in the 20th century, unemployment and poverty increased. The town faced many challenges, including poor housing, lack of jobs, and social problems.

In recent years, Merthyr Tydfil has been working hard to improve. The local council has invested in tourism, education, and public spaces. The nearby Brecon Beacons National Park brings visitors to the area, and attractions like Cyfarthfa Castle Museum and BikePark Wales have helped to bring new life to the town. Many people are proud of Merthyr's tough past and hopeful about its future.

Reading Comprehension Questions

1.1 – Identify the main point of the text

1. What is the main focus of this text?
   a) To explain how to visit Merthyr Tydfil
   b) To describe the food and drink in Merthyr
   c) To give a historical overview of Merthyr Tydfil
   d) To tell the story of one man's life in Merthyr

1.2 – Identify the main events / ideas

2. List **three** important events or changes in Merthyr Tydfil's history.

---

3. What happened during the Merthyr Rising?

1.3 – Use language features to identify meaning

4. What does the phrase *“smoke, fire, and steam”* suggest about life in Merthyr during the Industrial Revolution?
   a) It was peaceful and green
   b) It was full of heavy industry and pollution
   c) It was cold and quiet
   d) It was full of sunshine and clean air

5. What does the phrase *“working hard to improve”* suggest about Merthyr today?
   a) The town has stopped trying to improve
   b) The people have moved away
   c) The town is making positive changes
   d) Nothing has changed in the town

1.4 – Identify the meaning of vocabulary in context

6. What does *innovation* mean in paragraph 4?
   a) A type of coal
   b) A traditional method
   c) A new idea or invention
   d) A protest

7. What does *unemployment* mean in paragraph 6?
   a) People without homes
   b) People without jobs
   c) People without education
   d) People without money

3.1 – Obtain specific information

8. Who tested the first steam-powered railway locomotive, and where?

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9. What are two modern attractions that help bring visitors to Merthyr today?

3.2 – Evaluate information from different sources

10. How is Merthyr Tydfil’s past described in the text?

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11. How does the text describe the present situation in Merthyr?

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12. In your opinion, what lessons can be learned from Merthyr Tydfil’s history?

Week 19 Extra Reading Practice

Task: Read the text on the pros and cons of a popular social media platform and answer the questions below:

The Pros and Cons of Instagram

Instagram is one of the most popular social media platforms in the world. Launched in 2010, it allows users to share photos, videos, and stories with friends and followers. While many people enjoy using Instagram, there is an ongoing debate about its effects on users, especially young people.

One of the biggest advantages of Instagram is **self-expression**. Users can be creative by sharing their photography, artwork, fashion, or daily life. Some people use it as an online diary, while others enjoy following their favourite influencers or celebrities. For many, Instagram is a fun way to connect with others and feel part of a wider community.

Instagram can also be a **powerful business tool**. Many small businesses and individuals use it to advertise their products or services. It's a free platform, and if used well, it can help people grow their brand and reach new customers. Influencers, for example, can earn money by working with companies to promote products.

Another benefit is **inspiration**. Instagram offers millions of images related to travel, food, fitness, fashion, and more. Some people say it motivates them to try new things, such as healthy recipes, workouts, or DIY projects.

However, Instagram is not without its downsides. One major concern is **mental health**. Research shows that spending a lot of time on the platform can lead to anxiety, low self-esteem, and body image issues—especially among teenagers. Because users often post only the best parts of their lives, it can create unrealistic expectations. People may feel pressure to look perfect or live an exciting life, which isn't always real.

There is also the problem of **addiction**. Many users find themselves scrolling for hours without realising. Instagram is designed to keep users engaged, with endless content and notifications. This can affect sleep, concentration, and even relationships.

Privacy is another issue. Some users share too much personal information, which can be risky. There have also been problems with cyberbullying, online scams, and fake accounts. Although Instagram has tools to report abuse and block users, it doesn't always stop harmful behaviour.

In conclusion, Instagram can be a great platform for creativity, business, and connection, but it also has negative effects that should not be ignored. Like most things, it can be positive if used in moderation and with awareness. Understanding both the pros and the cons can help users make better decisions about how they use social media.

Reading Comprehension Questions

1.1 – Identify the main point of the text

1. What is the main purpose of this text?
   a) To teach people how to become influencers
   b) To explain how Instagram makes money
   c) To present the advantages and disadvantages of Instagram
   d) To describe the history of social media

1.2 – Identify the main ideas

2. Name **three benefits** of using Instagram mentioned in the text.

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3. Name **two problems** with using Instagram that the writer discusses.

1.3 – Use language features to identify meaning

4. What does the phrase *"endless content and notifications"* suggest?
   a) Instagram is boring and repetitive
   b) Instagram doesn't allow users to post
   c) There is always something new to look at
   d) Users have to wait for new content

5. What does *"Instagram is designed to keep users engaged"* suggest about the platform's purpose?
   a) It tries to help people relax
   b) It's made to encourage people to spend more time on it
   c) It encourages people to read books
   d) It helps users focus on work

1.4 – Identify the meaning of vocabulary in context

6. What does *self-expression* mean in paragraph 2?
   a) Being silent
   b) Showing your personality or creativity
   c) Copying other people's ideas
   d) Feeling shy

7. What does *influencer* mean in the text?
   a) Someone who controls people
   b) Someone who posts content and encourages others to buy or do things

c) A person who writes books
d) A computer expert

3.1 – Obtain specific information from text

8. In which year was Instagram launched?

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9. Name two features that Instagram offers to users.

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10. What are two examples of negative effects Instagram may have on users?

3.2 – Evaluate information from different sources

11. According to the writer, what are the **positive effects** of Instagram?

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12. According to the writer, what are the **negative effects** of Instagram?

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13. What do you think? Do you believe Instagram is more helpful or more harmful? Give reasons for your opinion.